

brothers rapidly amassed \$4.5 billion worth of silver (much of it being flown to Switzerland in specially designed planes under armed guard),⁴⁰ pushing the price to nearly \$50 per ounce. Ultimately, the U.S. government had to step in to prevent further manipulation, which ultimately ruined the brothers' ploy and fortunes, as silver dropped back to \$11 per ounce on March 27, 1980.⁴¹

Other notable instances of cornering markets reveal that this vulnerability spans asset classes:

- In 1929 over a hundred companies listed on the NYSE were cornered.⁴²
- From April 1987 to March 1989, the Tokyo Stock Exchange estimated that one out of every 10 companies listed on its exchange was cornered.⁴³
- In the middle of 1991, Salomon Brothers was caught trying to manipulate U.S. Treasuries, widely regarded as one of the safest investment instruments in the world.⁴⁴
- In the mid-1990s, Yasuo Hamanaka pushed the cost of copper on the London Metals Exchange up by over 75 percent to \$3,200 and was rewarded with a seven-year prison sentence.

Pumping, Dumping, and Cornering Cryptoassets

Cryptoassets that have small network values are particularly susceptible to the cornering of their markets. For example, at the start of April 2017, the 200 smallest cryptoassets had markets of less than \$20,000. Therefore, a bad actor could